

Brother MFC-3820CN

The Brother MFC-3820CN has card reader slots that read MemoryStick, Compact Flash, Secure Digital and Smart Media formats. As you plug the memory card in, a dialog box provides options to open the folder or print it.

The printer head produces 5 picolitre drops, while a Canon photo printer manages drops as small as 2 picolitres. Hence, the 3820CN lags far behind in image sharpness and details. However, images printed from the Compact Flash card at the best settings on glossy and inkjet paper had vivid colours and crisp details.

The combi-document print-out also returned good prints. The text printout, though, had lots of smudging all over and looked like a print from a dot-matrix printer.

The scanned image had endless banding, and details



were lost. Also, it took 17 seconds to scan the preview, whereas the Epson CX3100 took just 6.25 seconds. The ADF, however scans quickly while copying.

It has a dial-pad and separate fax buttons on the front panel to straight away send/receive the fax without any help from PC.

The printer has four separate ink-cartridges

(CMYK), which is good approach as it lets you change only the empty cartridges. The black cartridge costs Rs 910, where as the three-colour cartridges are priced at Rs 531 each, which is quite a competitive price.

The integration of its paper trays leaves very little, or no chance of them being damaged. In all, it's an all-round solution for the small office.

- + Good print quality
- Poor scanning unit

SPECIFICATIONS

1 line x 16 character LCD Display, 16 MB memory, 20 sheets automatic document feeder, Max. 600 x 2400dpi optical resolution, USB 2.0

Brother MFC-3820CN B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 27,600+ taxes
Contact: Godrej & Boyce Mfg Co Ltd
Phone: 022-55961609
E-mail: nad@godrej.com
Web Site: www.brother.com

Dell Inspiron 600m

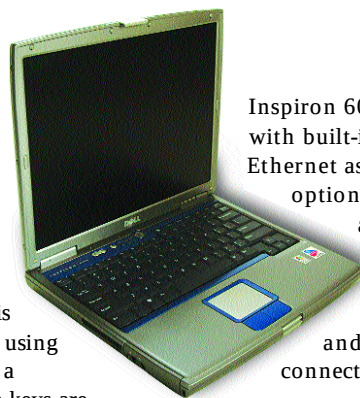
If you want a performance-oriented laptop, the Dell Inspiron 600m fits the bill. It's excellent value for money.

Performance separates it from the crowd. It beat our January 2004 comparison winner, the IBM ThinkPad T40. But higher performance means that the battery lasts only three hours.

The Inspiron 600m is based on the Centrino platform, is powered by a Pentium M 1.7 GHz, 512 MB of DDR memory, a 64 MB Radeon 9000 display card and 40 GB of hard disk space. It weighs 2.3 Kg.

The design is a perfect blend of aesthetics and practicality. Ergonomics is spot-on, and using the laptop is a pleasure. The keys are reasonably large and well-laid out. The touch pad is sensitive and accurate, but the touch pad buttons lack the feel associated with quality laptops. Overall, however, the build quality is superb.

For connectivity, the



Inspiron 600m comes with built-in Wi-Fi and Ethernet as well as an optional Bluetooth adapter. Video options include one monitor D-sub and an S-Video connector.

- + Excellent performance
- Flimsy touch pad buttons

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium M 1.7 GHz, 512 MB of DDR RAM, 32 MB Radeon display card, built-in Wi-Fi card, combo drive, optional Bluetooth adapter

Dell Inspiron 600m A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 90,690
Contact: Dell Computer India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1600-338044
Fax: 080-25586107
E-mail: HSB_Web_India@Dell.com
Web site: www.dell.com

Overall Performance (Out of 35)	
Dell Inspiron 600m	25.4
IBM T40	24.9

Orite VC3240

The Orite VC3240 is not worth Rs 7,950. Indoor images were not of acceptable quality, and outdoor images, just about average.

Details were lost in an extreme close-up: the crystal pen stand we shot looked like a plastic stand. We couldn't get better results even though the camera features exposure compensation, four pre-defined white-balance settings and two settings for quality.

At factory settings, indoor images were dark, and had prominent red tinges in the light areas and green tinges the dark areas—neither the colours nor details were reproduced well. For usable images, you have to rely on the manual mode.

It's compact enough to fit in most palms. A nice mode dial does the switching between operational modes—manual, auto, movie and so on.

But that's all you are paying for.

- + Good looks
- Below-average quality images

SPECIFICATIONS

3.2 megapixel CMOS sensor, 4x digital zoom, 16 MB internal memory, ±2EV exposure, four white balance settings, 20 cm macro mode, four AAA batteries required, 2 to 10 seconds self timer, 110 gms

Price: Rs 7,950
Contact: Mediatech India
Phone: 022-26361111
Fax: 022-24968085
E-mail: csales@mediatechindia.com
Web site: www.rite.com.tw

Orite VC3240 C	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶